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APPSC GROUP-1 MAINS
2026–27

Paper II

History, Culture & Geography of India and Andhra Pradesh

Previous questions, sorted by syllabus · with practice questions



90 Previous questions
2020, 2023 and 2025 papers

9 Syllabus parts
how many came from each

54 Practice questions
on every part, including recent news

BY

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Syllabus as per APPSC Notification 07/2026

Paper II at a glance

How many previous questions came from each part of the syllabus.

30 questions in the 2020 paper + **30** questions in the 2023 paper + **30** questions in the 2025 paper = **90** questions in this book

Each paper has 15 questions, and each question gives a choice of (a) or (b), so 30 questions per paper. Questions 1–5 are on Indian history, 6–10 on Andhra history, and 11–15 on geography.

Part	Syllabus part	2020	2023	2025	Total	Page
1	Ancient India	2	2	2	6	2
2	Medieval India	4	4	4	12	3
3	British Rule and India's Freedom Struggle	4	4	4	12	5
4	Ancient and Medieval Andhra	4	4	4	12	8
5	Modern Andhra and the Freedom Movement	4	4	2	10	10
6	United Andhra Pradesh and the 2014 Split	2	2	4	8	12
7	Land, Climate, Rivers and Natural Resources	2	2	2	6	14
8	Farming, Industry and People	4	4	4	12	15
9	Wildlife, Environment and Disasters	4	4	4	12	17
	All parts	30	30	30	90	

ASKED THE MOST

Medieval India

12 of 90 questions, about 1 in every 8.

RISING THE MOST

Part 6: 2 → 2 → 4

United Andhra Pradesh and the 2014 Split, in 2020, 2023, 2025.

ASKED THE LEAST

Ancient India

Only 6 of 90 questions.

Each part of this book has three things: ① how many questions came from each topic ② the exact questions asked ③ practice questions to write.

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PART 1 OF 9

Ancient India

1

India from the Stone Age and the Indus cities to the Guptas: early religions, empires and travellers' accounts.

6	2	2	2
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
Stone Age and the Indus Valley (Harappan) Civilization	1	1	1	**3**
Vedic age, Buddhism and Jainism	1	0	1	**2**
Mauryas, Ashoka and the Kushans	0	0	0	**0**
Satavahanas, Sangam age and Guptas; foreign travellers	0	1	0	**1**

2 The questions asked

Stone Age and the Indus Valley (Harappan) Civilization

asked 3 times

2025 Q1(a) — Discuss the origin and expansion of the Indus Valley Civilization.

2023 Q1(a) — Examine the survival and continuity of Harappan culture in the present times.

2020 Q1(a) — Critically explain the salient features of urban planning of Harappan Civilization.

Vedic age, Buddhism and Jainism

asked 2 times

2025 Q1(b) — Briefly analyze the teachings of Buddha and Mahavira.

2020 Q1(b) — Critically explain the causes of the emergence of Buddhism in ancient India.

Mauryas, Ashoka and the Kushans

not asked yet

Satavahanas, Sangam age and Guptas; foreign travellers

asked 1 time

2023 Q1(b) — Examine the socio-religious life and administration of early India with respect to the writings of Chinese travellers such as Fa-Hien, Hiuen-Tsang and I-Tsang.

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3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 VEDIC AGE, BUDDHISM AND JAINISM ● IN THE NEWS

In 2025, the Piprahwa relics of the Buddha returned to India after 127 years. Why are such relics important, and how should India bring back its heritage from abroad?

P2 VEDIC AGE, BUDDHISM AND JAINISM

Compare the Early Vedic and Later Vedic periods in terms of society, religion and economy.

P3 MAURYAS, ASHOKA AND THE KUSHANS

Explain the main ideas of Ashoka's Dhamma. Why is Ashoka called a unique ruler in world history?

P4 MAURYAS, ASHOKA AND THE KUSHANS

Who were the Kushans? Discuss Kanishka's contribution to Buddhism, art and trade.

P5 SATAVAHANAS, SANGAM AGE AND GUPTAS; FOREIGN TRAVELLERS

Why is the Gupta period called the 'Golden Age' of ancient India? Do you agree?

P6 SATAVAHANAS, SANGAM AGE AND GUPTAS; FOREIGN TRAVELLERS

Describe ancient Nalanda as a centre of learning. Why is it remembered even today?

PART 2 OF 9

Medieval India

2

Southern kingdoms, the Delhi Sultans, Bhakti and Sufi saints, the Mughals and Marathas, and the arrival of Europeans.

12	4	4	4
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
South Indian kingdoms (Pallavas, Chalukyas, Cholas and others)	1	1	1	**3**
Delhi Sultanate	0	1	0	**1**
Bhakti and Sufi movements; regional languages and arts	1	0	1	**2**
Mughals, Shivaji and the Marathas	2	2	0	**4**
Arrival of Europeans and the East India Company	0	0	2	**2**

2 The questions asked

South Indian kingdoms (Pallavas, Chalukyas, Cholas and others)

asked 3 times

2025 Q2(a) — Describe the contributions of the Chalukya rulers of Kalyani in the fields of sculpture, architecture, and literature.

2023 Q2(a) — Examine the manner in which the Chola village administration had contributed to the growth of village autonomy as indicated by the Uttaramerur/Uttaramallur inscriptions.

2020 Q2(a) — Draw an outline of society under the Eastern Chalukyas.

Delhi Sultanate

asked 1 time

2023 Q2(b) — Explain Alauddin Khilji's market regulations and discuss their impact.

Bhakti and Sufi movements; regional languages and arts

asked 2 times

2025 Q2(b) — Describe the characteristics of the Sufi movement and assess its impact on Indian culture.

2020 Q2(b) — Vividly examine the impact of Bhakti Movement during medieval India.

Mughals, Shivaji and the Marathas

asked 4 times

2023 Q3(a) — Discuss the features of Mughal architecture and examine the influence of Hindu elements on Mughal architecture.

2023 Q3(b) — 'The state that was [illegible] Shivaji was not only egalitarian in conception but also a welfare state in nature.' Examine.

2020 Q3(a) — Critically evaluate the central administration under Akbar.

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2020 Q3(b) Draw an outline of the rise of Maratha Empire with special reference to Shivaji's contribution.

Arrival of Europeans and the East India Company

asked 2 times

2025 Q3(a) Discuss the establishment of the East India Company and its early operations in India.

2025 Q3(b) What impact did the activities of Christian missionaries have on Indian society and culture?

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 MUGHALS, SHIVAJI AND THE MARATHAS ● IN THE NEWS

In 2025, the 'Maratha Military Landscapes of India' were added to UNESCO's World Heritage List. Describe the military system and fort-building of Shivaji and the Marathas.

P2 SOUTH INDIAN KINGDOMS (PALLAVAS, CHALUKYAS, CHOLAS AND OTHERS) ● IN THE NEWS

In 2025, India marked 1,000 years of Rajendra Chola I's sea expedition to Southeast Asia. Explain the naval power and overseas influence of the Cholas.

P3 DELHI SULTANATE

Describe the administration of the Delhi Sultanate, with special reference to the iqta system.

P4 BHAKTI AND SUFI MOVEMENTS; REGIONAL LANGUAGES AND ARTS

How did the Bhakti saints help the growth of regional languages and literature in India?

P5 SOUTH INDIAN KINGDOMS (PALLAVAS, CHALUKYAS, CHOLAS AND OTHERS)

Describe the contribution of the Rashtrakutas to art and architecture, with reference to the Kailasa temple at Ellora.

P6 SOUTH INDIAN KINGDOMS (PALLAVAS, CHALUKYAS, CHOLAS AND OTHERS)

Discuss the contributions of the Bahmani kingdom to administration and architecture in the Deccan.

PART 3 OF 9

British Rule and India's Freedom Struggle

3

How the British took over and ruled India, the reformers who changed society, and the long fight for freedom up to 1947 and after.

12	4	4	4
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
British expansion and land revenue systems	1	1	1	**3**
1857 Revolt and social reformers	0	1	0	**1**
Congress and the national movement (Gandhi, Bose, Patel, Ambedkar)	2	0	3	**5**
Peasant, tribal and workers' movements; communalism	0	2	0	**2**
Independence, Partition and nation-building after 1947	1	0	0	**1**

2 The questions asked

British expansion and land revenue systems

asked 3 times

2025 Q4(a) — What do you understand by the Permanent Settlement, and what impact did it have on Indian society? Comment.

2023 Q4(a) — Explain the land revenue systems that were introduced by the British. Assess the impact of these revenue systems on the Indian economy.

2020 Q4(a) — Critically explain the role of Subsidiary Alliance system in the rise and expansion of British Raj in India.

1857 Revolt and social reformers

asked 1 time

2023 Q4(b) — Assess the socio-religious reform movements in the Muslim community during the 19th century. Discuss the contributions made by Sayyid Ahmad Khan towards the upliftment of the Muslim community.

Congress and the national movement (Gandhi, Bose, Patel, Ambedkar)

asked 5 times

2025 Q4(b) — What do you understand by the 'safety valve' theory? Explain it in the context of the Indian National Congress?

2025 Q5(a) — Discuss the role and contributions of the moderate leaders of Congress from 1885 to 1905.

2025 Q5(b) — Describe the major movements led by Mahatma Gandhi between 1920 and 1947.

2020 Q4(b) — Delineate the contribution of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar with special reference to the conditions of untouchables and labourers in colonial India?

2020 Q5(b) — Critically evaluate the impact of Quit India Movement of 1942.

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Peasant, tribal and workers' movements; communalism

asked 2 times

2023 Q5(a) — Explain the factors that led to the peasant movement in India and examine its impact on the national movement in India.

2023 Q5(b) — Has communalism indirectly helped the British to perpetuate their control over India? Examine the indicative traits of the Communalists and assess their impact on India's modern history.

Independence, Partition and nation-building after 1947

asked 1 time

2020 Q5(a) — Examine the recommendations of the Cabinet Mission plan.

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 CONGRESS AND THE NATIONAL MOVEMENT (GANDHI, BOSE, PATEL, AMBEDKAR) ● IN THE NEWS

In 2025–26, India marked 150 years of 'Vande Mataram'. Explain the role of this song in the Swadeshi movement and the freedom struggle.

P2 INDEPENDENCE, PARTITION AND NATION-BUILDING AFTER 1947 ● IN THE NEWS

India celebrated Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary in 2025. Explain his role in integrating the princely states into India.

P3 PEASANT, TRIBAL AND WORKERS' MOVEMENTS; COMMUNALISM ● IN THE NEWS

Birsa Munda's 150th birth anniversary was celebrated as Janjatiya Gaurav Varsh in 2024–25. Discuss the causes and importance of tribal revolts against British rule.

P4 1857 REVOLT AND SOCIAL REFORMERS

What were the causes of the Revolt of 1857? Why did it fail?

P5 1857 REVOLT AND SOCIAL REFORMERS

Compare the social reform ideas of Jyotiba Phule and Sree Narayana Guru.

P6 INDEPENDENCE, PARTITION AND NATION-BUILDING AFTER 1947

Why were Indian States reorganised on the basis of language in 1956? Was it the right decision?

PART 4 OF 9

Ancient and Medieval Andhra

4

Andhra's own kingdoms from the Satavahanas to Vijayanagara and the Qutb Shahis: their religion, temples, forts and Telugu literature.

12	4	4	4
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
Early Andhra kingdoms (Satavahanas to Vishnukundins)	2	1	1	**4**
Eastern Chalukyas; origins of Telugu people and language	0	1	1	**2**
Kakatiyas, Reddis, Gajapatis and Vijayanagara	2	2	2	**6**
Qutb Shahis and people's poets like Vemana	0	0	0	**0**

2 The questions asked

Early Andhra kingdoms (Satavahanas to Vishnukundins)

asked 4 times

2025 Q7(b) — How did far trade routes contribute to the exchange of Buddhist ideas in ancient Andhra?

2023 Q6(a) — Discuss the socio-religious conditions during the Satavahana period with special reference to prominence bestowed on women.

2020 Q6(a) — Discuss salient features of the Agrarian system under the Satavahanas.

2020 Q6(b) — Write a note on art and architecture under the Pallavas.

Eastern Chalukyas; origins of Telugu people and language

asked 2 times

2025 Q7(a) — What are the various stories about the origins of Andhra people and the Andhra language?

2023 Q6(b) — Explain the re-structuring of the socio-religious life of the Eastern Chalukyas with reference to the impact caused by immigrations, caste mobility and social awakening.

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Kakatiyas, Reddis, Gajapatis and Vijayanagara

asked 6 times

2025 Q8(a)	Discuss the growth of various Saivite sects during the Kakatiya rule.
2025 Q8(b)	Discuss the significance of the Warangal Fort complex as a historical monument.
2023 Q7(a)	Examine the socio-religious and cultural life of the Vijayanagara kingdom with respect to the writings of foreign travellers such as Nicolo Conti, Abdur Razzak, Duarte Barbosa and Domingo Paes.
2023 Q7(b)	Examine the socio-cultural and religious conditions of the Reddi kingdoms with specific reference to the development of Telugu literature.
2020 Q7(a)	Write a brief note on the architecture during the period of Vijayanagar Empire.
2020 Q7(b)	"The foundation of Vijayanagara Empire coincided in point of time with the outburst of a momentous literary movement in South India." Discuss it.

Qutb Shahis and people's poets like Vemana

not asked yet

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 EARLY ANDHRA KINGDOMS (SATAVAHANAS TO VISHNUKUNDINS) ● IN THE NEWS

In 2025, ancient inscriptions were found in the Lankamala forest of Kadapa district. How do inscriptions help us understand the history of Andhra?

P2 EARLY ANDHRA KINGDOMS (SATAVAHANAS TO VISHNUKUNDINS)

Describe the contribution of the Ikshvakus to Buddhism, with reference to Nagarjunakonda.

P3 KAKATIYAS, REDDIS, GAJAPATIS AND VIJAYANAGARA

Who were the Kavitraya? Explain their role in bringing the Mahabharata into Telugu.

P4 KAKATIYAS, REDDIS, GAJAPATIS AND VIJAYANAGARA

Who were the Ashtadiggajas? Describe the growth of Telugu literature under Sri Krishnadevaraya.

P5 QUTB SHAHIS AND PEOPLE'S POETS LIKE VEMANA

Discuss the contribution of the Qutb Shahis to the culture, language and architecture of the Andhra region.

P6 QUTB SHAHIS AND PEOPLE'S POETS LIKE VEMANA

Who was Vemana? Why are his poems still popular among Telugu people?

PART 5 OF 9

Modern Andhra and the Freedom Movement

5

Andhra under the British, its social reformers and writers, its freedom fighters, and the movement that created Andhra State and Andhra Pradesh.

10	4	4	2
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
Company rule in Andhra (Munro, C.P. Brown, Mackenzie)	0	1	0	**1**
Social awakening: reformers, library movement, press, women	2	1	2	**5**
Andhra in the freedom struggle (Justice Party, Alluri)	1	2	0	**3**
Andhra Movement: Potti Sreeramulu to Andhra Pradesh (1956)	1	0	0	**1**

2 The questions asked

Company rule in Andhra (Munro, C.P. Brown, Mackenzie)

asked 1 time

2023 Q8(b) — Write a short note on the following East India Company officials and their contributions : (i) Sir Thomas Munro (ii) Sir Arthur Cotton (iii) Charles Phillip Brown

Social awakening: reformers, library movement, press, women

asked 5 times

2025 Q9(a) — Discuss the role of missionaries in the growth and spread of education in Andhra region.

2025 Q9(b) — What factors contributed to the process of social awakening in the Andhra region in the second half of the 19th century?

2023 Q8(a) — Write a short note on the following : (i) Gurajada Apparao's contribution to social reform through the medium of literature (ii) Gidugu Ramamurthy's pioneering efforts to strengthen the Vyavaharika Bhasha movement

2020 Q8(a) — Write a brief account of library movement in Andhra Pradesh.

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2020 Q8(b) Critically evaluate the contribution of Kandukari Veeresalingam in the light of social reform movement in Andhra Pradesh.

Andhra in the freedom struggle (Justice Party, Alluri)

asked 3 times

2023 Q9(a) Examine the role of Alluri Sitarama Raju as the leader of Rampa Rebellion.

2023 Q9(b) The evolution of Telugu Dalit literature has led an ideological narrative against caste discrimination, and for a just and equal society with focus on self-respect and dignity. In this connection, examine the contributions made by the Dalit Poets.

2020 Q9(a) Critically explain the circumstances which led to the formation of Justice Party.

Andhra Movement: Potti Sreeramulu to Andhra Pradesh (1956)

asked 1 time

2020 Q9(b) Critically explain the circumstances which led to the formation of Andhra Pradesh in 1950s.

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 ANDHRA MOVEMENT: POTTI SREERAMULU TO ANDHRA PRADESH (1956) ● IN THE NEWS

In 2026, a 58-foot statue of Potti Sriramulu was unveiled at Amaravati on his 125th birth anniversary. Explain his role in the formation of Andhra State in 1953.

P2 ANDHRA IN THE FREEDOM STRUGGLE (JUSTICE PARTY, ALLURI) ● IN THE NEWS

2026 marks the 150th birth anniversary of Pingali Venkayya. Describe his life and his role in designing the national flag.

P3 SOCIAL AWAKENING: REFORMERS, LIBRARY MOVEMENT, PRESS, WOMEN

What role did newspapers such as Andhra Patrika and Krishna Patrika play in the national movement in Andhra?

P4 SOCIAL AWAKENING: REFORMERS, LIBRARY MOVEMENT, PRESS, WOMEN

Describe the role of women such as Ponaka Kanakamma and Dokka Seethamma in the social and national movements of Andhra.

P5 COMPANY RULE IN ANDHRA (MUNRO, C.P. BROWN, MACKENZIE)

Who was Colin Mackenzie? Explain the importance of the Mackenzie manuscripts for the history of Andhra.

P6 ANDHRA MOVEMENT: POTTI SREERAMULU TO ANDHRA PRADESH (1956)

Explain the role of the Andhra Mahasabhas in the movement for a separate Andhra State.

PART 6 OF 9

United Andhra Pradesh and the 2014 Split

6

Andhra Pradesh from 1956 to 2014, why it was divided, and what the division meant for the capital, money, jobs, water and business.

8	2	2	4
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
United AP 1956–2014 and the agitations	0	0	2	**2**
Loss of Hyderabad and the new capital (Amaravati)	0	0	2	**2**
AP Reorganisation Act 2014: assets, employees, water	0	2	0	**2**
Economic effects of the 2014 split	2	0	0	**2**

2 The questions asked

United AP 1956–2014 and the agitations

asked 2 times

2025 Q10(a) — What were the provisions of the Gentlemen's Agreement of 1956? How far could they satisfy apprehensions of the Telangana region?

2025 Q10(b) — Outline the role of the students in raising major issues in the 1969 Telangana agitation.

Loss of Hyderabad and the new capital (Amaravati)

asked 2 times

2025 Q6(a) — Examine the impact of the loss of Hyderabad as the capital city on post-bifurcation Andhra Pradesh. How did this transition affect the state's administrative, economic, and socio-cultural landscape?

2025 Q6(b) — Discuss the vision behind building a new capital for Andhra Pradesh after the bifurcation in 2014. Critically assess the financial implications involved in the planning, development, and partial execution of Amaravati as the capital city.

AP Reorganisation Act 2014: assets, employees, water

asked 2 times

2023 Q10(a) — Explain the inconsistencies of the Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act 2014 that had adversely affected the residuary state of Andhra Pradesh with regards to apportionment of assets and liabilities.

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2023 Q10(b) Examine the principles envisaged under Schedule Eleven of the Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act 2014, with reference to the functioning of the river management boards.

Economic effects of the 2014 split

asked 2 times

2020 Q10(a) Discuss the revenue and infrastructural challenges for new Andhra Pradesh after bifurcation in 2014.

2020 Q10(b) Discuss the impact of bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh (2014) on trade and commerce.

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 LOSS OF HYDERABAD AND THE NEW CAPITAL (AMARAVATI) ● IN THE NEWS

In 2026, Parliament gave Amaravati legal status as the capital of Andhra Pradesh. Trace the journey of the capital question since 2014.

P2 AP REORGANISATION ACT 2014: ASSETS, EMPLOYEES, WATER ● IN THE NEWS

Why has Telangana objected to the Polavaram–Banakacherla link project? Explain the river-water provisions of the AP Reorganisation Act, 2014.

P3 UNITED AP 1956–2014 AND THE AGITATIONS

What were the Mulki Rules? How did they affect relations between the regions of united Andhra Pradesh?

P4 UNITED AP 1956–2014 AND THE AGITATIONS

Explain the causes and course of the Jai Andhra movement of 1972–73.

P5 AP REORGANISATION ACT 2014: ASSETS, EMPLOYEES, WATER

How were government employees divided between Andhra Pradesh and Telangana after 2014? What problems arose?

P6 ECONOMIC EFFECTS OF THE 2014 SPLIT

Discuss the social and cultural impact of the 2014 bifurcation on the people of Andhra Pradesh.

PART 7 OF 9

Land, Climate, Rivers and Natural Resources

7

The physical map of India and Andhra Pradesh: landforms, climate, soils, rivers and dams, rocks and minerals, and types of forests.

6	2	2	2
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
Landforms of India and Andhra Pradesh	1	0	2	**3**
Climate and climate change	0	1	0	**1**
Soils, rivers and dams	1	1	0	**2**
Rocks, minerals and forest types	0	0	0	**0**

2 The questions asked

Landforms of India and Andhra Pradesh

asked 3 times

2025 Q11(a) — Explain the physical features of India and Andhra Pradesh, especially the major landforms and geographical characteristics.

2025 Q11(b) — Examine the features and importance of the major landforms of Andhra Pradesh with special reference to the Coastal Plains, Eastern Ghats, and Deccan Plateau.

2020 Q11(a) — Give a brief account of geographical features of Andhra Pradesh.

Climate and climate change

asked 1 time

2023 Q11(a) — What are the climatic controls? How do they influence India's climate ?

Soils, rivers and dams

asked 2 times

2023 Q11(b) — Describe the characteristic features of Black and Alluvial soils of Andhra Pradesh.

2020 Q11(b) — Give a brief account of the drainage system of Andhra Pradesh.

Rocks, minerals and forest types

not asked yet

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3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 CLIMATE AND CLIMATE CHANGE ● IN THE NEWS

In 2025, the monsoon reached Kerala on 24 May, one of its earliest arrivals in years. Explain how the monsoon works and why its arrival date changes.

P2 ROCKS, MINERALS AND FOREST TYPES ● IN THE NEWS

What are critical minerals? Explain the National Critical Mineral Mission and Andhra Pradesh's mineral potential.

P3 ROCKS, MINERALS AND FOREST TYPES

Describe the major types of forests found in Andhra Pradesh.

P4 ROCKS, MINERALS AND FOREST TYPES

Describe the major mineral resources of Andhra Pradesh and where they are found.

P5 LANDFORMS OF INDIA AND ANDHRA PRADESH

Compare the Eastern Ghats and the Western Ghats.

P6 SOILS, RIVERS AND DAMS

Describe the major reservoirs and irrigation projects on the Krishna and Godavari rivers in Andhra Pradesh.

PART 8 OF 9

Farming, Industry and People

8

How people earn a living (farms, fishing, factories, ports, trade) and who lives where: population, towns, tribes, castes, religions.

12	4	4	4
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
Farming, livestock, forests and fisheries	2	0	1	**3**
Industries, mining, transport and ports	0	2	1	**3**
Population, migration and urbanisation	1	1	1	**3**
Tribes, castes, religions, languages and settlements	1	1	1	**3**

2 The questions asked

Farming, livestock, forests and fisheries

asked 3 times

2025 Q12(a)	Discuss the background of agriculture in Andhra Pradesh and critically examine how key agricultural inputs such as rainfall, temperature, irrigation and power are likely to be affected by climate change.
2020 Q12(a)	Critically analyse the components and impacts of the Green Revolution in India.
2020 Q12(b)	Give a concise description of fisheries management and development in India?

Industries, mining, transport and ports

asked 3 times

2025 Q12(b)	Highlight the industrial importance and major manufacturing sectors of Andhra Pradesh.
2023 Q12(a)	What are the objectives and key features of Sagarmala Project ? Why is it important ?
2023 Q12(b)	Discuss the role of sea-ports in the economic development of Andhra Pradesh.

Population, migration and urbanisation

asked 3 times

2025 Q13(a)	Discuss the spatial patterns of population distribution and urbanisation in Andhra Pradesh.
2023 Q13(a)	Give a description of the 'demographic dividend' in the Indian context.
2020 Q13(a)	Write a brief note on the rural and urban population of Andhra Pradesh in the light of the census of India 2011.

Tribes, castes, religions, languages and settlements

asked 3 times

2025 Q13(b)	Analyse the composition and spatial distribution of Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), and religious communities in Andhra Pradesh, as per Census 2011.
2023 Q13(b)	What are different types of rural settlements and factors affecting them ? Add a note on rural settlement patterns in India.
2020 Q13(b)	Write a brief note on tribal population of Andhra Pradesh in the context of census report of 2011.

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 POPULATION, MIGRATION AND URBANISATION ● IN THE NEWS

Census 2027 will be held in two phases and will include caste enumeration. Why is a census important for planning, and what are the challenges in conducting it?

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P2 FARMING, LIVESTOCK, FORESTS AND FISHERIES ● IN THE NEWS

In 2025, high US tariffs hit Andhra Pradesh's shrimp exporters. Explain the importance of aquaculture to the State and the risks of depending on one export market.

P3 INDUSTRIES, MINING, TRANSPORT AND PORTS

Describe the road and rail network of Andhra Pradesh and its importance for the State's economy.

P4 POPULATION, MIGRATION AND URBANISATION

Why do people migrate from villages to towns in Andhra Pradesh? Explain the effects of this migration.

P5 TRIBES, CASTES, RELIGIONS, LANGUAGES AND SETTLEMENTS

What are the different types of urban settlements? Describe the growth of major cities in Andhra Pradesh.

P6 INDUSTRIES, MINING, TRANSPORT AND PORTS

Discuss the mineral-based and forest-based industries of Andhra Pradesh.

PART 9 OF 9

Wildlife, Environment and Disasters

9

Animals, plants and their protection; pollution and sustainable development; cyclones, floods, droughts and how we manage disasters.

12	4	4	4
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
Wildlife, forests and biodiversity	2	2	1	**5**
Pollution, sustainable development and EIA	2	1	1	**4**
Cyclones, floods, droughts and disaster management	0	1	2	**3**

2 The questions asked

Wildlife, forests and biodiversity

asked 5 times

2025 Q14(a) Discuss the key aspects of wildlife conservation and biodiversity in Andhra Pradesh.

2023 Q14(a)	Discuss various forest conservation strategies in India.
2023 Q14(b)	Discuss various in situ conservation strategies of biodiversity in Andhra Pradesh.
2020 Q14(a)	In the light of the All India Tiger Estimation Report 2018, critically evaluate the Project Tiger.
2020 Q14(b)	Briefly describe the flora and fauna of National Parks in Andhra Pradesh.

Pollution, sustainable development and EIA

asked 4 times

2025 Q15(b)	Assess the role of the Andhra Pradesh Pollution Control Board (APPCB) in post-disaster pollution management.
2023 Q15(a)	What is meant by Environment Impact Assessment ? Evaluate it. Also give suggestions to make it effective.
2020 Q15(a)	Give a brief account of factors responsible for environmental pollution.
2020 Q15(b)	Give a brief account of the concept and importance of Sustainable Development.

Cyclones, floods, droughts and disaster management

asked 3 times

2025 Q14(b)	Discuss the vulnerability of Andhra Pradesh to cyclones and floods, highlighting the causes, regional patterns, and impacts.
2025 Q15(a)	Analyse the disaster vulnerability of Rayalaseema region in Andhra Pradesh with respect to droughts. Discuss the socio-economic consequences.
2023 Q15(b)	Define 'Drought'. What are its different types ? Add a note on drought prone areas in India.

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 CYCLONES, FLOODS, DROUGHTS AND DISASTER MANAGEMENT ● IN THE NEWS

Cyclone Montha crossed the Andhra Pradesh coast in October 2025. Explain how cyclones form in the Bay of Bengal and why AP's coast is so exposed to them.

P2 CYCLONES, FLOODS, DROUGHTS AND DISASTER MANAGEMENT ● IN THE NEWS

In August 2025, a cloudburst caused a deadly flash flood at Dharali in Uttarakhand. What is a cloudburst, and why are such events increasing in the Himalayas?

P3 CYCLONES, FLOODS, DROUGHTS AND DISASTER MANAGEMENT

Which parts of India are most prone to earthquakes? Explain the causes and the ways to reduce damage.

Learn with Anil

P4 WILDLIFE, FORESTS AND BIODIVERSITY

Describe the important bird sanctuaries of Andhra Pradesh, such as Kolleru and Pulicat.

P5 POLLUTION, SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT AND EIA

How has globalisation affected the environment in India?

P6 WILDLIFE, FORESTS AND BIODIVERSITY

What causes human–wildlife conflict in Andhra Pradesh, such as elephant raids in Chittoor district? Suggest solutions.

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